New Year's Eve & Global Countdown Trivia

20 questions on famous ball drops, movie moments, history and traditions around the world

How to Play

1. Split guests into teams of 2 to 5 and hand each team a pen and paper.
2. Read each question and its four options aloud twice. Give teams 30 seconds to write a letter.
3. Score 1 point per correct answer. Tied teams face a sudden-death question of your choosing.
4. Fun twist: time the game so the final question ends right before the midnight countdown!

Questions

1. In what year did the very first ball drop in New York's Times Square?

A) 1888
B) 1907
C) 1925
D) 1955

2. Which Pacific nation's Line Islands are among the very first places on Earth to ring in the new year?

A) New Zealand
B) Japan
C) Kiribati
D) Fiji

3. What do people in Spain traditionally eat at the stroke of midnight for good luck?

A) Twelve grapes, one per chime
B) A slice of turrón
C) Twelve olives
D) A bowl of lentils

4. Which poet wrote the words to "Auld Lang Syne"?

A) Sir Walter Scott
B) Lord Byron
C) William Wordsworth
D) Robert Burns

5. In *When Harry Met Sally* (1989), where does Harry finally declare his love for Sally?

A) At a wedding
B) At a New Year's Eve party
C) At the airport
D) At Thanksgiving dinner

6. In Denmark, what do people throw against friends' front doors on New Year's Eve?

A) Snowballs
B) Confetti
C) Old plates and dishes
D) Eggs

7. Bandleader Guy Lombardo made "Auld Lang Syne" a New Year's staple with which orchestra?

A) The Royal Canadians
B) The Midnight Swingers
C) The Manhattan Serenaders
D) The Times Square Players

8. "Hogmanay" is the name for New Year's Eve celebrations in which country?

A) Ireland
B) Norway
C) Wales
D) Scotland

9. The Times Square ball drop was created after New York City banned what at New Year's?

A) Bonfires
B) Fireworks
C) Church bells
D) Street parades

10. January is named after which two-faced Roman god of beginnings and endings?

A) Jupiter
B) Mars
C) Janus
D) Saturn

11. Which Roman leader introduced the calendar that made January 1 the start of the year?

A) Julius Caesar
B) Augustus
C) Nero
D) Constantine

12. In Brazil, beachgoers jump over how many waves at midnight for good luck?

A) Three
B) Seven
C) Ten
D) Twelve

13. During Japan's "Joya no Kane" ceremony, how many times are Buddhist temple bells rung?

A) 12
B) 50
C) 100
D) 108

14. In Ecuador, what do families burn at midnight to say goodbye to the old year?

A) Old shoes
B) Christmas trees
C) Life-size effigies called "años viejos"
D) Love letters

15. Who created and hosted the long-running TV special *New Year's Rockin' Eve*, first aired in 1972?

A) Dick Clark
B) Johnny Carson
C) Merv Griffin
D) Bob Barker

16. In which 1972 disaster movie does a giant wave flip a cruise ship right at midnight on New Year's Eve?

A) *Titanic*
B) *The Poseidon Adventure*
C) *Jaws*
D) *Airport*

17. The "Y2K bug" panic was over fears that computers would read the year 2000 as which year?

A) 1999
B) 2001
C) 2100
D) 1900

18. In the Philippines, families often display how many round fruits for a prosperous new year?

A) Seven
B) Ten
C) Twelve
D) Twenty

19. In Russia, which gift-bringer traditionally visits on New Year's Eve rather than Christmas?

A) Ded Moroz (Grandfather Frost)
B) Sinterklaas
C) Père Noël
D) Julenisse

20. In Colombia, people hoping to travel in the new year walk around the block carrying what?

A) An umbrella
B) An empty suitcase
C) A broom
D) A pot of rice

Answer Key

For the host's eyes only!

#	Answer	#	Answer
1	**B)** 1907	**11**	**A)** Julius Caesar
2	**C)** Kiribati	**12**	**B)** Seven
3	**A)** Twelve grapes, one per chime	**13**	**D)** 108
4	**D)** Robert Burns	**14**	**C)** Life-size effigies called "años viejos"
5	**B)** At a New Year's Eve party	**15**	**A)** Dick Clark
6	**C)** Old plates and dishes	**16**	**B)** *The Poseidon Adventure*
7	**A)** The Royal Canadians	**17**	**D)** 1900
8	**D)** Scotland	**18**	**C)** Twelve
9	**B)** Fireworks	**19**	**A)** Ded Moroz (Grandfather Frost)
10	**C)** Janus	**20**	**B)** An empty suitcase